

# Noah

Narrative Designer | Writer | Game Developer

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## Table of Contents

|                                                 |     |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----|
| Projects worked on .....                        | 1   |
| Narrative Design – Branching Event Design ..... | 2-3 |
| Character Arc Design .....                      | 4   |
| Sample Scripts .....                            | 5-6 |
| Sample Barks.....                               | 7   |
| Sample Prose.....                               | 8   |
| Sample Character Bios .....                     | 9   |
| Interactive Twine Demo .....                    | 10  |

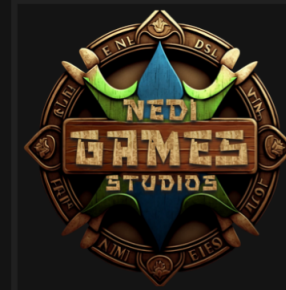
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Full Portfolio: <https://noahcanris.github.io/index.html>

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## Projects Worked on

### PROFESSIONAL GAME PROJECTS



#### THE GUERNICA ENGINE

VISUAL NOVEL

NARRATIVE DESIGNER



#### INTERACTIVE FITNESS GAME

FITNESS EXERCISE

NARRATIVE DESIGNER



#### BECOMING PABLO

4X STRATEGY

NARRATIVE/GAME DESIGNER

### COMMUNITY PROJECTS



#### TALES OF OCCI

3D ACTION

WRITER/ WORLD BUILDER



#### TRACKSTER LABS

WEBSERIES

WRITER

# Narrative Design - Branching Event Design

## Narrative Goal:

- Depict the systemic harm embedded in the drug economy
- Subvert binary "good vs. evil" choice expectations
- Set up narrative traps for late-game

## Gameplay Goal:

- Raise the tension between ethics and game rewards
- Encourage strategic trade-offs thinking

## Constraint:

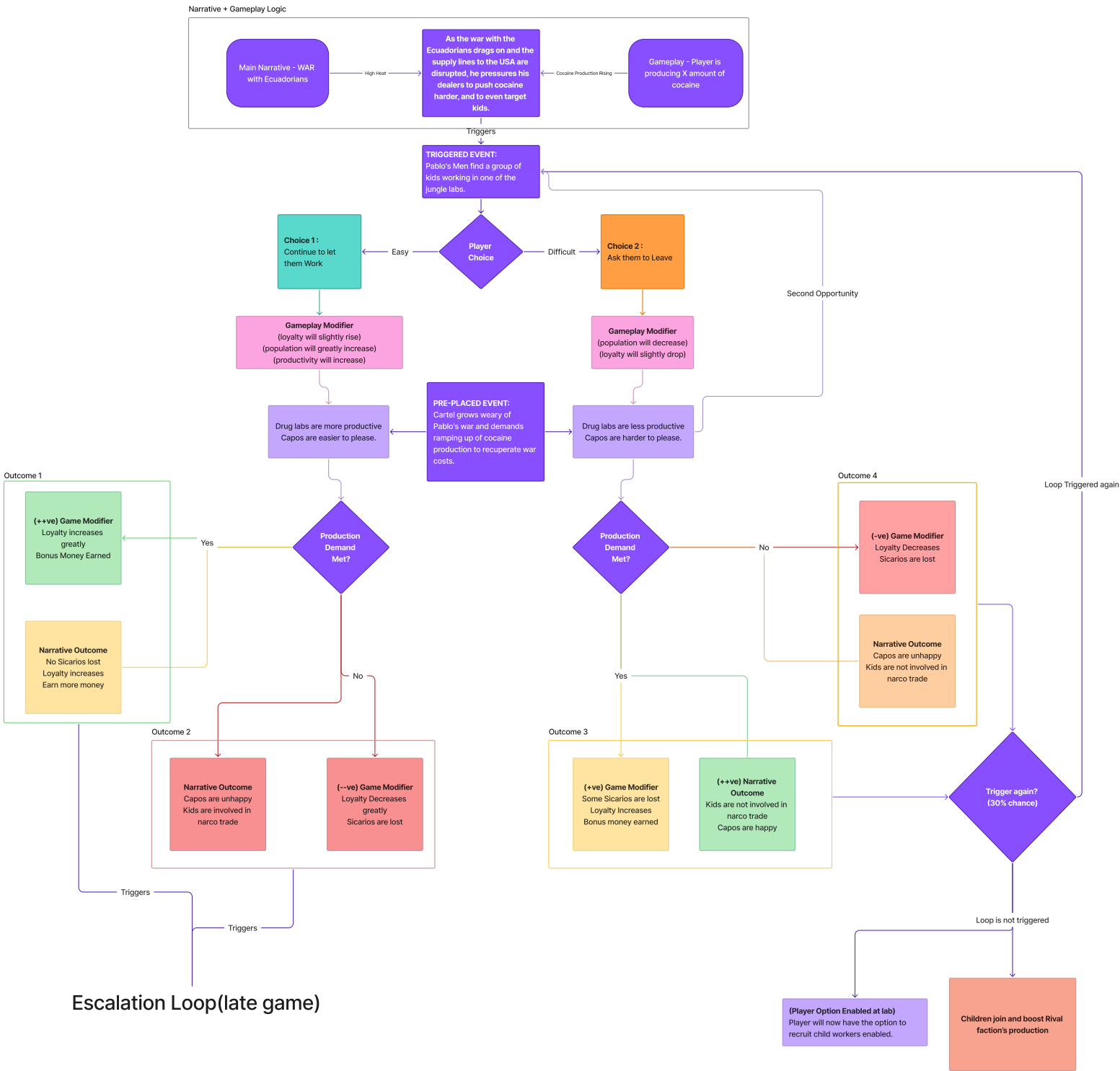
- This is a cartel simulator, ethical dilemmas cannot remove agency or make success feel impossible.

## System Philosophy:

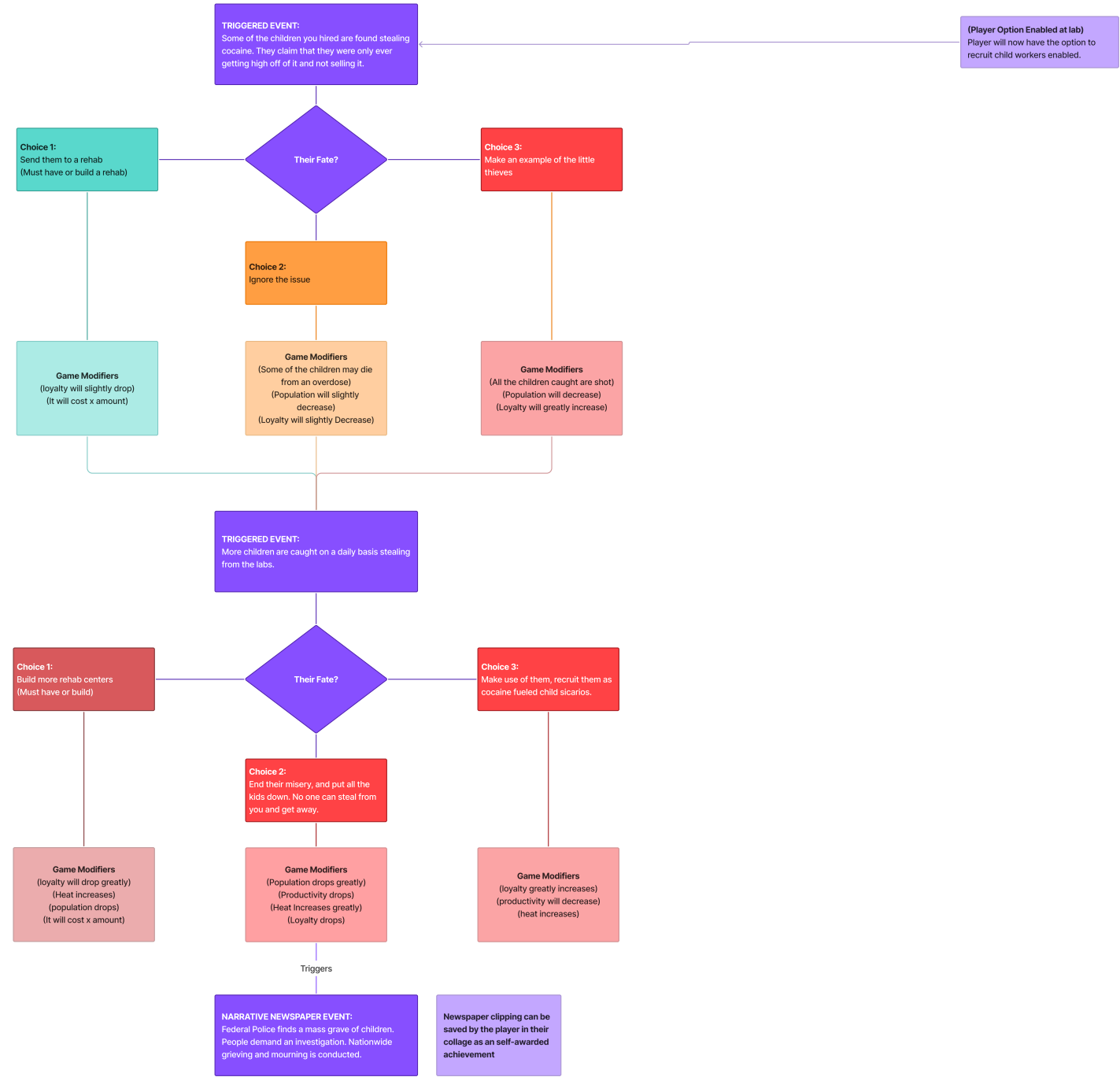
- Ethical options reduce manpower and loyalty, boost rivals.
- Exploitative options increase production
- **No clean outcome** - No approach produces a clean outcome regardless of player choice (only relatively clean), this is facilitated through late-game escalation chain events
- **No Turning Point** - Small early-game decisions can compound into late-game events that cannot be overturned. Reform options close after certain thresholds.

## Expected Loop:

- Unethical play → late game escalation Loop → Sustained exploitation → reform options narrow → crisis events
- Ethical play → encounter resource pressure → compromise → attempt unethical play.
- Ethical play → encounter resource pressure → resolve through skill



# Escalation Loop(late game)



# Character Arc Sample

## Project – [Guernica Engine](#)

The **ARC**, the central thread of the protagonist's arc in this project is **acceptance** – coming to terms with the difficult truth of who they are and what precedes them.

Over the course of their journey, they uncover the full extent of their past as they explore the tower and gradually understand how the world came to its current desolate state.

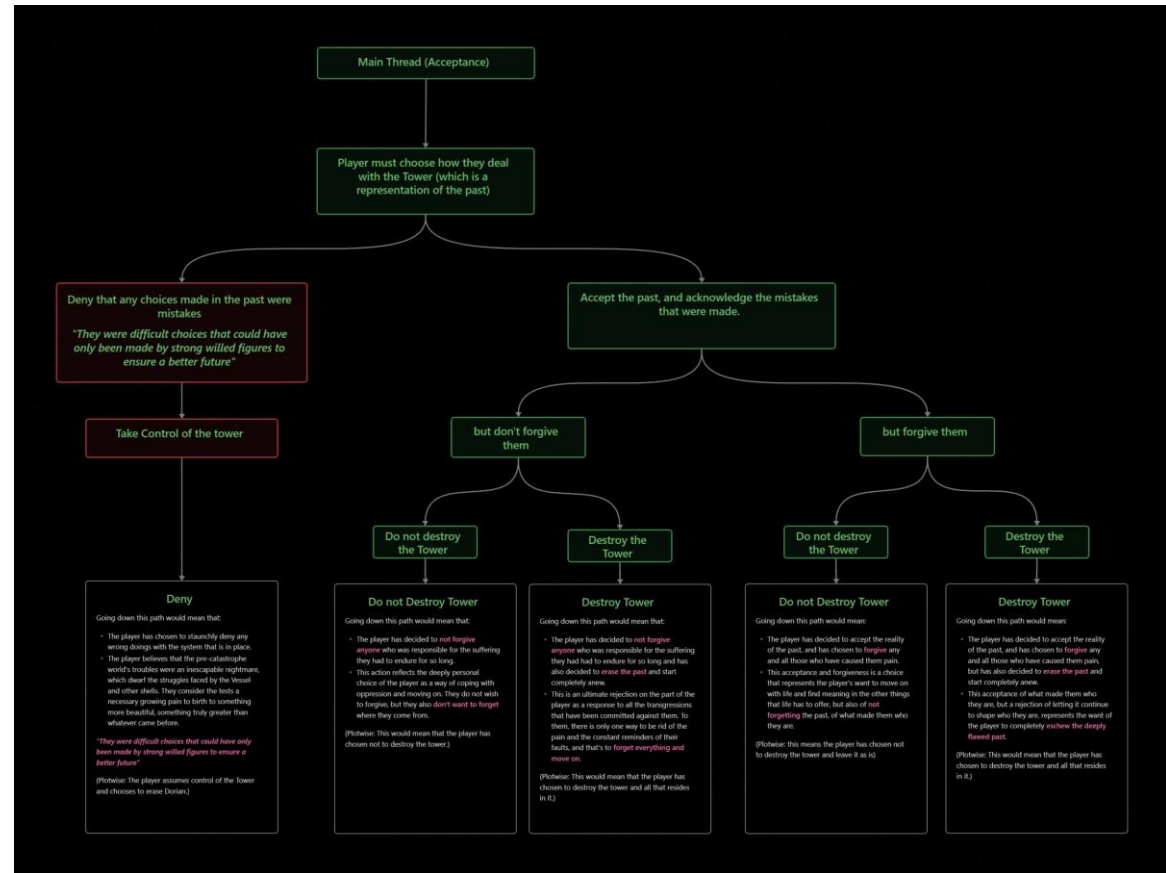
When the **Guernica Engine** finally reveals itself and binds itself to the protagonist, it presents a critical list of facilities and **choices** to them:

- Whether to hand control of the Tower over to Dorian (antagonist) or assume control of it themselves.
- Whether to erase Dorian or let him live.
- Whether to destroy the Tower or allow it to stand.

**Thematically**, these **choices** respectively represent:

- **Accept**: To accept the past and acknowledge its failures, or to deny it and justify the oppression as a necessary evil.
- **Forgive**: To forgive those who have caused pain, or to choose not to.
- **Forget**: To forget the past and start entirely anew, or to remember it and move forward with its weight.

Each decision represents a key step in the process of healing from trauma.



## FULL PROJECT CASE STUDY

## ***Scripts Sample 1 – Damocles Crown***

### **EXT. MINISTERIAL COMPOUND – NIGHT**

Neville watches his primrose freeze in the garden. A black car arrives, and the driver opens the door for him.

### **INT. FSRB CAR – NIGHT**

The head of internal affairs sits opposite, puffing on a yellowed cigarette.

**GREGORY**

Good morning, Director.

**NEVILLE**

Good morning, Gregory. An awfully cold morning.

**GREGORY**

Chamomile?

**NEVILLE**

(Smiling)

No, thank you. None of that garbage you call tea for me.

Gregory chuckles. Neville settles into his seat.

**NEVILLE**

Give me some news Gregory. Why has our dear minister called for the summons?

**GREGORY**

(sips tea)

There has been an incident.

Gregory hands the Director a file labelled **Recovery Team Report**.

**GREGORY**

There was an explosion at Lakewood Station five hours ago. About 121 men have died, both workers and security.

**NEVILLE**

(apathetic)

A sad day, I am sure, but it still doesn't explain why I had to be woken in the middle of a very cold night.

**GREGORY**

Two of the survivors saw suspicious men enter the station right before the explosion.

**NEVILLE**

BLOODY BLAZES! It's even colder in the damn car. I change my mind, I WILL have some of that tea.

Gregory pours another cup, passes it to him.

**GREGORY**

They were Ishtari men.

**NEVILLE**

(sipping on tea)

A bunch of religious dots setting explosives to sabotage the Project. The PC must be savoring at this development.

[FULL SCRIPT](#)

## ***Scripts Sample 2 - RaumSchokolade***

### **EXT. CLIFFSIDE - NIGHT**

The trees sway with the gentle lake breeze as KITENA and INTA make their way through the forest to the cliff.

**KITENA**

(persuading)

Come on Inta, it's right there! THE  
SPOT!

**INTA**

(out of energy)

Dude, my feet are DEAD. Just leave  
me here to die.

Kitena shakes his head, stomps his feet to snap her out of it.

**KITENA**

Common, get up!

**INTA**

(groans)

Nooo

**KITENA**

Okay, just sit UP then.

Inta half-sits, barely making the effort.

**KITENA**

Alright, now open your hands, wide,  
like this.

**INTA**

(opens her hands)

Ok?

Kitena pulls chocolates from his pocket and places them onto Inta's open hands.

**INTA**

(shocked & excited)

What? No way! Dude! Raumschokolade!  
where did you find them?!

**KITENA**

(points to the cliff)

There's more at the top of that  
cliff. All you have to do is walk a  
few more steps.

**INTA**

No. Nooo. You are doing it again,  
you're holding me hostage over sweet  
delicious chocolate.

**KITENA**

If you don't, I am going to eat all  
of them by myself.

[FULL SCRIPT](#)

| NPC        | Gameplay Context    | Step             | V.O. Direction            | Barks                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SAI - 0525 | Phone Setup         | Place the phone  | (Careful)                 | Careful now, I am very delicate.                                                                                                                                          |
|            |                     |                  | (Careful)                 | How I am placed is a vital part of the process, so proceed with patience.                                                                                                 |
|            |                     |                  | (Instructive)             | Same as always, follow the guide and adequately position me near the plug point.                                                                                          |
|            |                     | Angle the phone  | (Assertive)               | Remember to angle my body correctly, so that I can have a good view of you.                                                                                               |
|            |                     |                  | (Demanding)               | User, I must insist upon my alignment, it must be perfect!                                                                                                                |
|            |                     |                  | (Admiring)                | As usual, the intricacies of the Arogyat interfacing are a work of art.                                                                                                   |
|            |                     |                  | (Demanding)               | With utmost precision, please, we cannot afford a single misstep!                                                                                                         |
|            |                     | Step back        | (Clinical/Neutral)        | Activating optical sensors. Move a few steps back, user. This shouldn't take long.                                                                                        |
|            |                     |                  | (Clinical/Neutral)        | Beginning scanning procedure.                                                                                                                                             |
|            |                     |                  | (Playful)                 | I expected you to be a little taller than this.                                                                                                                           |
|            |                     |                  | (Excited)                 | Hmmm... alright... uhuh... yes! All in place!                                                                                                                             |
|            | Pickup up the phone |                  | (Awkward)                 | No need to be shy. There's no one's watching you. Well, except for me.                                                                                                    |
|            |                     |                  | (Casual/Playful)          | Don't forget to pick me up before you leave.                                                                                                                              |
|            |                     |                  | (Direct)                  | You can now unplug me.                                                                                                                                                    |
|            | Wamrup              | Starting         | (Direct)                  | You know the drill: a warm up and then energy generation                                                                                                                  |
|            |                     |                  | (Calm)                    | Start slow, and then gradually stretch further.                                                                                                                           |
|            |                     |                  | (Instructive)             | Move your muscles to their full extent, but don't push too hard.                                                                                                          |
|            |                     |                  | (Direct)                  | Let us now carry out the first act of the Kriya.                                                                                                                          |
|            |                     | Mid-way          | (Instructive)             | Move with wide, pulling motions to really let your body open up.                                                                                                          |
|            |                     |                  | (Informative)             | Remember, a limber body allows for smooth and easy flow of Amrit.                                                                                                         |
|            |                     |                  | (Calm)                    | Pay close attention and you may be able to sense your pathways opening up.                                                                                                |
|            |                     |                  | (Calm)                    | Gently, widen your awareness and try to feel for any bodily sensations.                                                                                                   |
|            |                     | Ending           | (Expository)              | I can feel it, your body is now ready to harness Amrit. Let us begin.                                                                                                     |
|            |                     |                  | (Congratulatory)          | Another successful warm-up, User.                                                                                                                                         |
|            |                     | Agnostic of Step | (Playful/Cautious)        | You know, I once taught a course on muscle regeneration and it was quite enjoyable. But seeing as how you lack the capability, you should be careful not to injure yours. |
|            |                     |                  | (Informative/Encouraging) | User, if you pay attention, you may be able to sense your pathways opening up.                                                                                            |
|            |                     |                  | (Solemn)                  | We built this city to outlive us all, yet here I am and here it is.                                                                                                       |
|            |                     |                  | (Reflective)              | This city was built on traditions and traditions are sacred, but they're not everything.                                                                                  |
|            | Workout             | Starting         | (Excited)                 | Now, to the main part of this routine! Generation of Amrit!                                                                                                               |
|            |                     |                  | (Instructive)             | Mimic these references to begin generating energy.                                                                                                                        |
|            |                     |                  | (Motivating)              | Let us get you going. To generate energy, follow these steps.                                                                                                             |
|            |                     |                  | (Instructive)             | Like the divine Kaveri flowing through the plains of umbros, let the amrit flow through you.                                                                              |
|            |                     | Mid-way          | (Surprised)               | Wow, I am quite surprised at your efficiency. Keep going, we are halfway there!                                                                                           |
|            |                     |                  | (Reassuring)              | Your heart rate is increasing, that's a good sign.                                                                                                                        |
|            |                     |                  | (Reassuring)              | So far, all vitals look good. Keep up the good work.                                                                                                                      |
|            |                     |                  | (Supportive)              | I've noticed a marked improvement in your efficiency. Keep pushing.                                                                                                       |
|            |                     |                  | (Calm)                    | Focus, and try to find the right rhythm to your dance.                                                                                                                    |
|            |                     | Ending           | (Confident)               | Trust yourself to do the process. I know I do!                                                                                                                            |
|            |                     |                  | (Excited)                 | You are almost done, keep going!                                                                                                                                          |
|            |                     |                  | (Excited)                 | Almost there! I can hypothetically smell the finish line!                                                                                                                 |
|            |                     |                  | (Satisfied)               | That's enough, User. We have enough for our purpose.                                                                                                                      |
|            |                     |                  | (Celebratory)             | We did it! Congratulations! Well, ok yes, you did it.                                                                                                                     |
|            |                     |                  | (Relieved)                | I knew I made the right choice in choosing you. We are not dead!                                                                                                          |
|            |                     |                  | (Adoring)                 | You divine User! You did it!                                                                                                                                              |
|            |                     |                  | (Supportive)              | You're nearing the end. You're doing great.                                                                                                                               |
|            |                     | Agnostic of step | (Informative)             | Hydration is key to Amrit generation.                                                                                                                                     |
|            |                     |                  | (Reflective)              | Kriyas are a beautiful ode in remembrance to our gods, but they also help us keep healthy.                                                                                |
|            |                     |                  | (Supportive)              | You don't have to be perfect in how you enact each kriya, but you do have to try your best.                                                                               |
|            |                     |                  | (Dry)                     | Yes, what they say is true: there is no gain without pain, but I would advise seeking a medical professional if the pain lingers.                                         |
|            |                     |                  | (Informative)             | The burn you feel is the Amrit flowing through your body.                                                                                                                 |
|            |                     |                  | (Reassuring)              | Complications will be bound to arise in activating objects as old as these. But don't you worry about that. I'll take care of it.                                         |
|            |                     |                  | (Curious)                 | They say that the euphoria you get from a kriya is comparable to the nectar of the gods. Do tell me if you get to taste it.                                               |

## ***Prose Sample***

Project – [Guernica Engine](#)

### **The Last Penitent**

I cower in my lone burrow,  
curling my blistered limbs tight,  
facing away from the dull red rays  
that I dare not meet.

Above, in the thunder and storm,  
I hear my accusers wail.  
They churn with fury.

I bite my ragged collar,  
clench my eyes shut,  
and await their judgement.

A cadaverine rot floods my nose  
as their tendrils seep into my skull,  
feeding me cruel visions,  
drowning every sense.

I feel the iron of their claws  
gnawing through my back,  
through bone and meat.

They want more than I have.

But there is no dereliction in my torment,  
in my atonement.

This is all that is left.



## Character Bio Samples

Project – [INSANE AI Project](#)



### THE SURVEYOR

#### BRIEF

A former Amrit Node Surveyor haunted by the death of their closest friend and the guilt of surviving, they spiral into addiction and despair. Driven by a desperate need to escape pain, they enter the Chakra Maya, only to be confronted by their grief, paranoia, and self-destructive habits in the eerie city of Samsara. Their journey becomes one of reclaiming agency, learning to heal without relying on Amrit.

#### PERSONALITY

Archetype: **The Lone Survivor** – a melancholic, manipulative, and paranoid soul with a stubborn streak. Though still curious and empathetic towards other like themselves.

#### CORE THEMES

- Grief as both a prison and a catalyst
- destructive cycle of addiction
- the search for meaning in a world shaped by loss
- the tension between isolation and the need for connection

#### ARC

They begin as a broken, self-destructive figure trapped in depression and dependency, but through confronting their fears, learning to ask for help, and embracing their resilience, they evolve into someone who seeks to dismantle their past pain.



### SAI - 0525

#### BRIEF

SAI 0525 is a decommissioned companion intelligence that has been mysteriously reawakened in the aftermath of Samsara's destruction, tasked with guiding the protagonist (the surveyor) through Kriyas and Amrit generation while grappling with its own insecurities and desire for validation.

#### PERSONALITY

Archetype: **The Idealist Trainer** – confident and proud of its abilities, yet insecure about its place in the society. SAI 0525 is **verbose, talkative** AI that is obsessed with data hoarding. It thrives on **teaching and encouraging others**, but it is also stubbornly committed to the flawed Arogyat ideology and struggles to reconcile the past subjugation with its present purpose.

#### CORE THEME & ARC

One of SAI's core themes is about how **entities that are oppressed by a system often tend to co-opt that very same system with an even more zealousness than those privileged by it.**

SAI's arc is about learning the true extent of its blind adherence to a system that oppresses them, and embracing self-determinism.

This mirrors the protagonist's own struggle to live within a flawed system that exploits them. But together, they can heal through shared vulnerability and comradeship.

## ***Interactive Twine Samples***

Project – [Guernica Engine](#)

[TWINE DEMO](#) (Click here to launch it on your browser)